

EQ India: A Decade of Excellence and Future Vision



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What are the good practices that have led EQ India to become a centre of excellence?

EQ India's journey to becoming a centre of excellence is rooted in rigorous talent development, customer-centricity and innovation. We began by bringing outsourced back-office operations in-house, in 2014. This provided a strong base for our initiative to become a partner to EQ Group for critical activities, delivering efficiency in a manner that was compliant with stringent regulations.

Next, our talent management has been pivotal to our growth. We first look for candidates with the right attitude. Once on-board, we invest heavily in comprehensive training and skilling, since we are in a niche industry that requires a blend of technology expertise and domain knowledge. To create avenues for growth, we prioritize growth through our internal placement programs. This has worked well, evidenced by our 40% growth in 2024, directed mostly by internally promoted leaders. To encourage innovation and adaptability in our teams, we enable our colleagues to think differently and constantly strive for improvement. We help them recover quickly from setbacks too, since failures are inevitable. This empowering, multi-faceted approach has been appreciated by credible agencies including helping us win the Top Employer recognition from the Top Employer Institute three years in a row. Furthermore, every colleague is

encouraged to keep our core values of collaboration, trust, improvement, and commercial acumen in mind in everything they do, not just in the professional world but in their personal lives too. The robust foundation of our values ensures a global alignment in thinking and actions of our colleagues worldwide.

As a result, we have grown from a small team handling outsourced operations to a 2,000+ strong innovation-focused workforce constituting more than a third of our global headcount. Going beyond process replication, we are establishing functional Centres of Excellence that drive value for the entire EQ Group. The India centres unify our global processes, centralize innovation driven by company-wide inputs, and free up customer-facing teams to focus on client relationships.

What are the value additions of EQ in terms of enhancing employee capability on a global scale?

EQ India nurtures talent that can contribute to our global growth. Our approach, which incorporates the key tenets of our global talent policy, and the necessary additions as a GCC, focuses on continuous learning and mentoring.

We provide access to the latest learning platforms and encourage external certifications and self-improvement. We encourage our young colleagues to move towards excellence in their areas of interest. Through formal and informal processes, technical training and on-the-job mentoring, we expose employees to global and company best practices. Young leaders are paired with veterans who help them navigate challenges, creating a pipeline of future leaders with a global mindset.

We also understand the value of diversity and inclusion in creating a safe and supportive environment, where our teams can function at their best. Our "EmpowHer" program boosts women's leadership development. The Returning Mothers program helps new mothers integrate back into the workforce. There is comprehensive mental health support and a unique mechanism through the Peakon tool that captures anonymous monthly employee

feedback that leaders act on quickly.

All of these ensure we have a robust, colleague-friendly, learning environment that our colleagues can lean on as they develop into Global EQ citizens.

What are the future industry trends that EQ anticipates and its preparedness to meet those expectations?

Shareholder management is undergoing rapid digitization and automation, with a growing emphasis on user-centric platforms.

We are actively involved in EQ's worldwide initiatives related to digitization, self-service, data management, and cloud migration. We are also expanding our Centres of Excellence, the first of which was finance shared services, to include functions like procurement and project management. We are preparing to leverage data analytics for informed decision-making, ensuring we remain agile and responsive to customer needs.

While we are abreast of the technological advancements that aid the current industry shifts, our approach to adoption is measured and prioritizes cybersecurity and regulatory compliance. We meticulously evaluate new technologies, ensuring they align with these requirements. For us, technology is an enabler that simplifies and accelerates the services we provide our clients.

The vision forward of EQ for the next five years?

Over the next five years, we aim to solidify EQ India's position as a critical hub for the EQ Group, helping it achieve its vision of being the leading global share registrar and transfer agent, offering complementary services to our clients.

The Indian GCC sector itself is evolving rapidly. In this changing landscape, we will continue to drive innovation and technology transformation for the EQ Group.

We will continue to invest in our colleagues, equipping them to gain a global outlook. Last but not the least, we have always been committed to the ESG principles of sustainability, social impact, and robust governance, and these will remain key to our theme of inclusive growth.